

Mathematics Prerequisites

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1 Mathematics

Math is not just a way of calculating numerical answers; it is a way of thinking, using clear definitions for concepts and rigorous logic to organize our thoughts and back up our assertions.

Cheng (2025)

These lecture notes use:

- algebra
- precalculus
- univariate calculus
- linear algebra
- vector calculus

Some key results are listed here.

1.1 Elementary Algebra

Mastery of Elementary Algebra¹ (a.k.a. “College Algebra”) is a prerequisite for calculus, which is a prerequisite for Epi 202 and Epi 203, which are prerequisites for this course (Epi 204). Nevertheless, each year, some Epi 204 students are still uncomfortable with algebraic manipulations of mathematical formulas. Therefore, I include this section as a quick reference.

1.1.1 Equalities

Theorem 1.1 (Equalities are transitive). *If $a = b$ and $b = c$, then $a = c$*

Theorem 1.2 (Substituting equivalent expressions). *If $a = b$, then for any function $f(x)$, $f(a) = f(b)$*

1.1.2 Inequalities

Theorem 1.3. *If $a < b$, then $a + c < b + c$*

Theorem 1.4 (negating both sides of an inequality). *If $a < b$, then: $-a > -b$*

Theorem 1.5. *If $a < b$ and $c \geq 0$, then $ca < cb$.*

Theorem 1.6.

$$-a = (-1) * a$$

1.1.3 Sums

Theorem 1.7 (adding zero changes nothing).

$$a + 0 = a$$

Theorem 1.8 (Sums are symmetric).

$$a + b = b + a$$

Theorem 1.9 (Sums are associative).

When summing three or more terms, the order in which you sum them does not matter:

$$(a + b) + c = a + (b + c)$$

¹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Elementary_algebra

1.1.4 Products

Theorem 1.10 (Multiplying by 1 changes nothing).

$$a \times 1 = a$$

Theorem 1.11 (Products are symmetric).

$$a \times b = b \times a$$

Theorem 1.12 (Products are associative).

$$(a \times b) \times c = a \times (b \times c)$$

1.1.5 Division

Theorem 1.13 (Division can be written as a product).

$$\frac{a}{b} = a \times \frac{1}{b}$$

1.1.6 Sums and products together

Theorem 1.14 (Multiplication is distributive).

$$a(b + c) = ab + ac$$

1.1.7 Quotients

Definition 1.1 (Quotients, fractions, rates).

A **quotient**, **fraction**, or **rate** is a division of one quantity by another:

$$\frac{a}{b}$$

In epidemiology, rates typically have a quantity involving time or population in the denominator.

c.f. [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Rate_\(mathematics\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Rate_(mathematics))

Definition 1.2 (Ratios). A **ratio** is a quotient in which the numerator and denominator are measured using the same unit scales.

c.f. <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Ratio>

Definition 1.3 (Proportion). In statistics, a “proportion” typically means a ratio where the numerator represents a subset of the denominator.

See https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Population_proportion.

See also [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Proportion_\(mathematics\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Proportion_(mathematics)) for other meanings.

Definition 1.4 (Proportional). Two functions $f(x)$ and $g(x)$ are **proportional** if their ratio $\frac{f(x)}{g(x)}$ does not depend on x . (c.f. [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Proportionality_\(mathematics\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Proportionality_(mathematics)))

Additional reference for elementary algebra: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Population_proportion#Mathematical_definition

1.2 Exponentials and Logarithms

Theorem 1.15 (logarithm of a product is the sum of the logs of the factors).

$$\log a \cdot b = \log a + \log b$$

Corollary 1.1 (logarithm of a quotient).

The logarithm of a quotient is equal to the difference of the logs of the factors:

$$\log \frac{a}{b} = \log a - \log b$$

Theorem 1.16 (logarithm of an exponential function).

$$\log\{a^b\} = b \cdot \log\{a\}$$

Theorem 1.17 (exponential of a sum).

The exponential of a sum is equal to the product of the exponentials of the addends:

$$\exp\{a + b\} = \exp\{a\} \cdot \exp\{b\}$$

Corollary 1.2 (exponential of a difference).

The exponential of a difference is equal to the quotient of the exponentials of the addends:

$$\exp\{a - b\} = \frac{\exp\{a\}}{\exp\{b\}}$$

Theorem 1.18 (exponential of a product).

$$a^{bc} = (a^b)^c = (a^c)^b$$

Corollary 1.3 (natural exponential of a product).

$$\exp\{ab\} = (\exp\{a\})^b = (\exp\{b\})^a$$

Exercise 1.1. For $a \geq 0$, $b, c \in \mathbb{R}$, When does $(a^b)^c = a^{(b^c)}$?

Solution 1.1. Short answer: rarely (that's all you need to know for this course).

Long answer:

If $(a^b)^c = a^{(b^c)}$, then since $(a^b)^c = a^{bc}$, we have:

$$a^{bc} = a^{(b^c)}$$

$$\log\{a^{bc}\} = \log\{a^{(b^c)}\}$$

$$bc \cdot \log\{a\} = b^c \cdot \log\{a\} \tag{1}$$

Equation 1 holds in each of the following cases:

1. $bc = b^c$ (see Exercise 1.2).
2. $a = 1$ (i.e., $\log\{a\} = 0$).
3. $a = 0$ (i.e., $\log\{a\} = -\infty$) and $\text{sign}\{bc\} = \text{sign}\{b^c\}$.

In particular, when $a = 0$ and $c = 0$, $bc = 0$ and $b^c = 1$ (for any $b \in \mathbb{R}$), so $\text{sign}\{bc\} \neq \text{sign}\{b^c\}$, and $(a^b)^c \neq a^{(b^c)}$:

$$\begin{aligned}(a^b)^c &= (0^b)^0 \\ &= 1\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}a^{(b^c)} &= 0^{(b^0)} \\ &= 0^1 \\ &= 0\end{aligned}$$

Exercise 1.2. For $b, c \in \mathbb{R}$, when does $b^c = bc$?

Solution 1.2. $bc = b^c$ in each of the following cases:

1. $c = 1$.
2. $b = 0$ and $c > 0$.
3. $b = \exp\left\{\frac{\log c}{c-1}\right\}$ (for $c \geq 0$).

See the red contours in Figure 2 for a visualization.

```

`b*c_f` <- function(b, c) b*c
`b^c_f` <- function(b, c) b^c
values_b <- seq(0, 5, by = .01)
values_c <- seq(-.5, 3, by = .01)

`b*c` <- outer(values_b, values_c, `b*c_f`)
`b^c` <- outer(values_b, values_c, `b^c_f`)
`b^c`[is.infinite(`b^c`)] = NA

opacity <- .3
z_min <- min(`b*c`, `b^c`, na.rm = TRUE)
z_max <- 5
plotly::plot_ly(
  x = ~values_b,
  y = ~values_c
) |>
  plotly::add_surface(
    z = ~ t(`b*c`),
    contours = list(
      z = list(
        show = TRUE,
        start = -1,
        end = 1,
        size = .1
      )
    ),
    name = "b*c",
    showscale = FALSE,
    opacity = opacity,
    colorscale = list(c(0, 1), c("green", "green"))
  ) |>
  plotly::add_surface(
    opacity = opacity,
    colorscale = list(c(0, 1), c("red", "red")),
    z = ~ t(`b^c`),
    contours = list(
      z = list(
        show = TRUE,
        start = z_min,
        end = z_max,
        size = .2
      )
    ),
    showscale = FALSE,
    name = "b^c"
  ) |>
  plotly::layout(
    scene = list(
      xaxis = list(
        # type = "log",
        title = "b"
      ),
      yaxis = list(
        # type = "log",
        title = "c"
      ),
      zaxis = list(
        # type = "log",
        range = c(z_min, z_max),
        title = "outcome"
      ),
      camera = list(eye = list(x = -1.25, y = -1.25, z = 0.5)),
      aspectratio = list(x = 9, y = 8, z = 0.7)
    )
  )

```

```

`b^c - b*c_f` <- function(b, c) `b^c_f`(b,c) - `b*c_f`(b,c)

mat1 <- outer(values_b, values_c, `b^c - b*c_f`)
mat1[is.infinite(mat1)] = NA

opacity <- .3
plotly::plot_ly(
  x = ~values_b,
  y = ~values_c
) |>
  plotly::add_surface(
    z = ~ t(mat1),
    contours = list(
      z = list(
        show = TRUE,
        start = 0,
        end = 1,
        size = 1,
        color = "red"
      )
    ),
    name = "b^c - b*c",
    showscale = TRUE,
    opacity = opacity
  ) |>
  plotly::layout(
    scene = list(
      xaxis = list(
        # type = "log",
        title = "b"
      ),
      yaxis = list(
        # type = "log",
        title = "c"
      ),
      zaxis = list(
        title = "outcome"
      ),
      camera = list(eye = list(x = -1.25, y = -1.25, z = 0.5)),
      aspectratio = list(x = .9, y = .8, z = 0.7)
    )
  )

```

Theorem 1.19 ($\exp\{\}$ and $\log\{\}$ are mutual inverses).

$$\exp\{\log\{a\}\} = \log\{\exp\{a\}\} = a$$

2 Derivatives

Theorem 2.1 (Constant rule).

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial x} c = 0$$

Theorem 2.2 (Power rule). *If a is constant with respect to x , then:*

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial x} ay = a \frac{\partial x}{\partial y}$$

Theorem 2.3 (Power rule).

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial x} x^q = qx^{q-1}$$

Theorem 2.4 (Derivative of natural logarithm).

$$\log'\{x\} = \frac{1}{x} = x^{-1}$$

Theorem 2.5 (derivative of exponential).

$$\exp'\{x\} = \exp\{x\}$$

Theorem 2.6 (Product rule).

$$(ab)' = ab' + ba'$$

Theorem 2.7 (Quotient rule).

$$(a/b)' = a'/b - (a/b^2)b'$$

Theorem 2.8 (Chain rule).

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial a}{\partial c} &= \frac{\partial a}{\partial b} \frac{\partial b}{\partial c} \\ &= \frac{\partial b}{\partial c} \frac{\partial a}{\partial b} \end{aligned}$$

or in Euler/Lagrange notation²:

$$(f(g(x)))' = g'(x)f'(g(x))$$

Corollary 2.1 (Chain rule for logarithms).

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial x} \log f(x) = \frac{f'(x)}{f(x)}$$

Proof. Apply Theorem 2.8 and Theorem 2.4. □

²https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Notation_for_differentiation#Lagrange's_notation

3 Linear Algebra

3.1 Vectors

Definition 3.1 (Column vector). A **column vector** of length p is an ordered list of p numbers, written vertically:

$$\tilde{x} = \begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \\ \vdots \\ x_p \end{bmatrix}$$

Column vectors are the default convention in these notes and in most statistics textbooks. They are also called $p \times 1$ *matrices*.

Definition 3.2 (Transpose). The **transpose** of a column vector $\tilde{x}$ is the **row vector** with the same sequence of entries, written horizontally:

$$\tilde{x}^\top \equiv \tilde{x}' \equiv [x_1, x_2, \dots, x_p]$$

The transpose operation converts a column vector to a row vector, or more generally, swaps the rows and columns of a matrix (Definition 3.8).

3.1.1 Special vectors

Definition 3.3 (Zero vector). The **zero vector** $\tilde{0}$ of length p has all entries equal to zero:

$$\tilde{0} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

The zero vector is the additive identity for vector addition: $\tilde{x} + \tilde{0} = \tilde{x}$ for any vector $\tilde{x}$ of the same length.

Definition 3.4 (Ones vector). The **ones vector** $\tilde{1}$ of length p has all entries equal to one:

$$\tilde{1} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ \vdots \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

The dot product $\tilde{1}^\top \tilde{x} = \tilde{1} \cdot \tilde{x} = \sum_{i=1}^p x_i$ is the sum of all entries of $\tilde{x}$.

Definition 3.5 (Indicator vector / standard basis vector). The j -th **indicator vector** (or **standard basis vector**) $\tilde{e}_j$ of length p has a 1 in position j and 0s elsewhere:

$$(\tilde{e}_j)_i = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } i = j \\ 0 & \text{if } i \neq j \end{cases} \quad \tilde{e}_j = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \\ 1 \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \leftarrow \text{position } j$$

They are also called **unit vectors** or **standard basis vectors**.

Theorem 3.1 (Indicator vectors select entries). *For any vector $\tilde{x}$ of length p and any $j \in \{1, \dots, p\}$:*

$$\tilde{e}_j^\top \tilde{x} = x_j$$

Proof. Writing the product componentwise:

$$\begin{aligned} \tilde{e}_j^\top \tilde{x} &= \sum_{i=1}^p (\tilde{e}_j)_i x_i \\ &= \sum_{i=1}^p \begin{cases} 1 \cdot x_i & \text{if } i = j \\ 0 \cdot x_i & \text{if } i \neq j \end{cases} \\ &= x_j \end{aligned}$$

□

Definition 3.6 (Dot product/linear combination/inner product). For any two real-valued vectors $\tilde{x} = (x_1, \dots, x_n)$ and $\tilde{y} = (y_1, \dots, y_n)$, the **dot-product**, **linear combination**, or **inner product** of $\tilde{x}$ and $\tilde{y}$ is:

$$\tilde{x} \cdot \tilde{y} = \tilde{x}^\top \tilde{y} \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \sum_{i=1}^n x_i y_i$$

i Note

See also the definitions in

- Dobson and Barnett (2018), §1.3 (equation 1.1, page 7)
- Kaplan (2022), here^a.
- wikipedia^b

“Linear combination” can also refer to weighted sums of vectors, or in other words matrix-vector multiplication.

The dot-product has a different generalization for two matrices; see wikipedia^c for more.

^a<https://www.mosaic-web.org/MOSAIC-Calculus/Textbook/Linear-combinations/28-Vectors.html#geometry-arithmetic>

^bhttps://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Linear_combination

^chttps://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dot_product#Dyadics_and_matrices

Theorem 3.2 (Dot product is symmetric). *The dot product is symmetric:*

$$\tilde{x} \cdot \tilde{y} = \tilde{y} \cdot \tilde{x}$$

Proof. Apply:

- Definition 3.6
- symmetry of scalar multiplication
- Definition 3.6 again

□

Example 3.1 (Dot product as matrix multiplication). The dot product of two column vectors $\tilde{x}$ and $\tilde{\beta}$ can be written as a matrix product of the row vector $\tilde{x}^\top$ with the column vector $\tilde{\beta}$:

$$\begin{aligned}\tilde{x} \cdot \tilde{\beta} &= \tilde{x}^\top \tilde{\beta} \\ &= [x_1, x_2, \dots, x_p] \begin{bmatrix} \beta_1 \\ \beta_2 \\ \vdots \\ \beta_p \end{bmatrix} \\ &= x_1\beta_1 + x_2\beta_2 + \dots + x_p\beta_p\end{aligned}$$

3.2 Matrices

Definition 3.7 (Matrix). A **matrix** of dimensions $m \times n$ is a rectangular array of $m \cdot n$ numbers, arranged in m rows and n columns:

$$\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} a_{11} & a_{12} & \cdots & a_{1n} \\ a_{21} & a_{22} & \cdots & a_{2n} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ a_{m1} & a_{m2} & \cdots & a_{mn} \end{bmatrix}$$

The entry in row i and column j is denoted a_{ij} or $(\mathbf{A})_{ij}$. A column vector of length p is a special case: a $p \times 1$ matrix. A row vector of length p is a $1 \times p$ matrix.

3.2.1 Matrix transpose

Definition 3.8 (Matrix transpose). The **transpose** of an $m \times n$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$ is the $n \times m$ matrix $\mathbf{A}^\top$ obtained by swapping the rows and columns of $\mathbf{A}$:

$$(\mathbf{A}^\top)_{ij} = a_{ji}$$

Theorem 3.3 (Transpose of a sum).

$$(\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{B})^\top = \mathbf{A}^\top + \mathbf{B}^\top$$

In particular, for column vectors $\tilde{x}$ and $\tilde{y}$:

$$(\tilde{x} + \tilde{y})^\top = \tilde{x}^\top + \tilde{y}^\top$$

Theorem 3.4 (Transpose of a product). *For compatible matrices $\mathbf{A}$ and $\mathbf{B}$:*

$$(\mathbf{AB})^\top = \mathbf{B}^\top \mathbf{A}^\top$$

The order of the factors reverses when transposing a product.

3.2.2 Matrix addition

Definition 3.9 (Zero matrix). The $m \times n$ **zero matrix** $\mathbf{0}_{m \times n}$ (or $\mathbf{0}$ when dimensions are clear from context) has all entries equal to zero:

$$\mathbf{0}_{m \times n} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & \cdots & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & \cdots & 0 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & \cdots & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

Definition 3.10 (Matrix addition). Two matrices $\mathbf{A}$ and $\mathbf{B}$ of the same dimensions $m \times n$ can be added element-wise:

$$(\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{B})_{ij} = a_{ij} + b_{ij}$$

Theorem 3.5 (Matrix addition is commutative).

$$\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{B} = \mathbf{B} + \mathbf{A}$$

Theorem 3.6 (Matrix addition is associative).

$$(\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{B}) + \mathbf{C} = \mathbf{A} + (\mathbf{B} + \mathbf{C})$$

Theorem 3.7 (Zero matrix is the additive identity).

$$\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{0} = \mathbf{A}$$

Theorem 3.8 (Additive inverse). *For any matrix $\mathbf{A}$, the matrix $-\mathbf{A}$ (defined by $(-\mathbf{A})_{ij} = -a_{ij}$) satisfies:*

$$\mathbf{A} + (-\mathbf{A}) = \mathbf{0}$$

3.2.3 Scalar multiplication

Definition 3.11 (Scalar multiplication). A matrix $\mathbf{A}$ can be multiplied by a scalar c :

$$(c\mathbf{A})_{ij} = c \cdot a_{ij}$$

3.2.4 Matrix multiplication

Definition 3.12 (Matrix multiplication). The **product** of an $m \times k$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$ and a $k \times n$ matrix $\mathbf{B}$ is the $m \times n$ matrix $\mathbf{C} = \mathbf{AB}$ with entries:

$$c_{ij} = \sum_{s=1}^k a_{is} b_{sj}$$

Matrix multiplication is only defined when the number of columns in $\mathbf{A}$ equals the number of rows in $\mathbf{B}$.

Matrix multiplication is **not** commutative in general: $\mathbf{AB} \neq \mathbf{BA}$.

Theorem 3.9 (Matrix multiplication is associative).

$$(\mathbf{AB})\mathbf{C} = \mathbf{A}(\mathbf{BC})$$

Theorem 3.10 (Matrix multiplication is distributive over addition).

$$\mathbf{A}(\mathbf{B} + \mathbf{C}) = \mathbf{AB} + \mathbf{AC}$$

$$(\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{B})\mathbf{C} = \mathbf{AC} + \mathbf{BC}$$

3.2.5 Matrix-vector multiplication

Definition 3.13 (Matrix-vector multiplication). The product of an $m \times p$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$ and a $p \times 1$ column vector $\tilde{x}$ is the $m \times 1$ column vector $\mathbf{A}\tilde{x}$ with entries:

$$(\mathbf{A}\tilde{x})_i = \sum_{j=1}^p a_{ij} x_j$$

Matrix-vector multiplication is a generalization of the dot product. Each entry of the result is a dot product of a row of $\mathbf{A}$ with the vector $\tilde{x}$.

3.3 Special Matrices

See also Definition 3.9 for the zero matrix.

Definition 3.14 (Identity matrix). The $p \times p$ **identity matrix** $\mathbf{I}_p$ (or $\mathbf{I}$ when the size is clear from context) has ones on the main diagonal and zeros elsewhere:

$$(\mathbf{I}_p)_{ij} = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } i = j \\ 0 & \text{if } i \neq j \end{cases} \quad \mathbf{I}_p = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & \cdots & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & \cdots & 0 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & \cdots & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Theorem 3.11 (Identity matrix is a multiplicative identity). *For any $m \times p$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$:*

$$\mathbf{A}\mathbf{I}_p = \mathbf{A}$$

$$\mathbf{I}_m\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{A}$$

Definition 3.15 (Symmetric matrix). A square matrix $\mathbf{A}$ is **symmetric** if $\mathbf{A}^\top = \mathbf{A}$, i.e., $a_{ij} = a_{ji}$ for all i and j .

Covariance matrices and information matrices are symmetric.

Definition 3.16 (Diagonal matrix). A square matrix $\mathbf{D}$ is a **diagonal matrix** if all off-diagonal entries are zero: $d_{ij} = 0$ whenever $i \neq j$:

$$\mathbf{D} = \begin{bmatrix} d_1 & 0 & \cdots & 0 \\ 0 & d_2 & \cdots & 0 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & \cdots & d_p \end{bmatrix}$$

Diagonal matrices are denoted $\mathbf{D} = \text{diag}(d_1, d_2, \dots, d_p)$, where $d_1, \dots, d_p$ are the diagonal entries.

Definition 3.17 (Matrix inverse). For a square $p \times p$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$, the **inverse** $\mathbf{A}^{-1}$ (if it exists) is the unique matrix satisfying:

$$\mathbf{A} \mathbf{A}^{-1} = \mathbf{A}^{-1} \mathbf{A} = \mathbf{I}_p$$

A matrix that has an inverse is called **invertible** or **non-singular**.

Theorem 3.12 (Inverse of a product). *For invertible matrices $\mathbf{A}$ and $\mathbf{B}$:*

$$(\mathbf{AB})^{-1} = \mathbf{B}^{-1} \mathbf{A}^{-1}$$

3.4 Quadratic Forms

Definition 3.18 (Quadratic form). A **quadratic form** is a mathematical expression of the structure

$$\tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{S} \tilde{x}$$

where $\tilde{x}$ is a $p \times 1$ vector and $\mathbf{S}$ is a $p \times p$ matrix.

Quadratic forms are the matrix generalizations of the scalar expression cx^2 . They occur frequently in statistics:

- The residual sum of squares in linear regression
(1) is a quadratic form.
- The variance of a linear combination of estimates
(2) is a quadratic form: $\text{Var}\left(\tilde{x}^\top \hat{\beta}\right) = \tilde{x}^\top \text{Var}\left(\hat{\beta}\right) \tilde{x}$.

Theorem 3.13 (Symmetric part of a quadratic form). *If $\mathbf{S}$ is a square matrix, then*

$$\tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{S} \tilde{x} = \tilde{x}^\top \left(\frac{1}{2} (\mathbf{S} + \mathbf{S}^\top) \right) \tilde{x}.$$

So the value of a quadratic form depends only on the symmetric part of $\mathbf{S}$.

3.5 Design Matrix

Definition 3.19 (Design matrix). In a regression model with n observations and p predictors, the **design matrix** (or **model matrix**) $\mathbf{X}$ is the $n \times p$ matrix whose i -th row is the covariate vector $\tilde{x}_i^\top$ for observation i :

$$\mathbf{X} = \begin{bmatrix} \tilde{x}_1^\top \\ \tilde{x}_2^\top \\ \vdots \\ \tilde{x}_n^\top \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} x_{11} & x_{12} & \cdots & x_{1p} \\ x_{21} & x_{22} & \cdots & x_{2p} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ x_{n1} & x_{n2} & \cdots & x_{np} \end{bmatrix}$$

The product $\mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta}$ collects all the linear predictors $\tilde{x}_i^\top \tilde{\beta}$ into a single $n \times 1$ vector:

$$\mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta} = \begin{bmatrix} \tilde{x}_1^\top \tilde{\beta} \\ \vdots \\ \tilde{x}_n^\top \tilde{\beta} \end{bmatrix}$$

The matrix $\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X}$ is a $p \times p$ symmetric matrix that appears in the OLS estimator $\hat{\beta} = (\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X})^{-1} \mathbf{X}^\top \tilde{y}$.

4 Vector Calculus

(adapted from Fieller (2016), §7.2³)

This section covers derivatives of functions of vectors and matrices. Linear algebra prerequisites — including vectors, matrices, transpose, dot product, and quadratic forms — are covered in Chapter 3.

Let $\tilde{x}$ and $\tilde{\beta}$ be column vectors of length p (see Definition 3.1 and Definition 3.6).

Definition 4.1 (Vector derivative). If $f(\tilde{\beta})$ is a function that takes a vector $\tilde{\beta}$ as input, such as $f(\tilde{\beta}) = x' \tilde{\beta}$, then:

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}} f(\tilde{\beta}) = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{\partial}{\partial \beta_1} f(\tilde{\beta}) \\ \frac{\partial}{\partial \beta_2} f(\tilde{\beta}) \\ \vdots \\ \frac{\partial}{\partial \beta_p} f(\tilde{\beta}) \end{bmatrix}$$

Definition 4.2 (Row-vector derivative). If $f(\tilde{\beta})$ is a function that takes a vector $\tilde{\beta}$ as input, such as $f(\tilde{\beta}) = x' \tilde{\beta}$, then:

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}^\top} f(\tilde{\beta}) = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{\partial}{\partial \beta_1} f(\tilde{\beta}) & \frac{\partial}{\partial \beta_2} f(\tilde{\beta}) & \cdots & \frac{\partial}{\partial \beta_p} f(\tilde{\beta}) \end{bmatrix}$$

Theorem 4.1 (Row and column derivatives are transposes).

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}^\top} f(\tilde{\beta}) = \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}} f(\tilde{\beta}) \right)^\top$$

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}} f(\tilde{\beta}) = \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}^\top} f(\tilde{\beta}) \right)^\top$$

³<https://www.taylorfrancis.com/chapters/mono/10.1201/9781315370200-7/vector-matrix-calculus-nick-fieller?context=ubx&refId=c310b723-786a-4f33-ae56-720a6cccd3a1>

Theorem 4.2 (Derivative of a dot product).

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}} \tilde{x} \cdot \tilde{\beta} = \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}} \tilde{\beta} \cdot \tilde{x} = \tilde{x}$$

This looks a lot like non-vector calculus, except that you have to transpose the coefficient.

Proof.

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial}{\partial \beta} (x^\top \beta) &= \begin{bmatrix} \frac{\partial}{\partial \beta_1} (x_1 \beta_1 + x_2 \beta_2 + \dots + x_p \beta_p) \\ \frac{\partial}{\partial \beta_2} (x_1 \beta_1 + x_2 \beta_2 + \dots + x_p \beta_p) \\ \vdots \\ \frac{\partial}{\partial \beta_p} (x_1 \beta_1 + x_2 \beta_2 + \dots + x_p \beta_p) \end{bmatrix} \\ &= \begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \\ \vdots \\ x_p \end{bmatrix} \\ &= \tilde{x} \end{aligned}$$

□

Theorem 4.3 (Derivative of a quadratic form). *For a quadratic form (Definition 3.18), if S is a $p \times p$ matrix that is constant with respect to β , then:*

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial \beta} \beta' S \beta = 2S\beta$$

This is like taking the derivative of cx^2 with respect to x in non-vector calculus.

Corollary 4.1 (Derivative of a simple quadratic form).

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}} \tilde{\beta}' \tilde{\beta} = 2\tilde{\beta}$$

This is like taking the derivative of x^2 .

Theorem 4.4 (Vector chain rule).

$$\frac{\partial z}{\partial \tilde{x}} = \frac{\partial y}{\partial \tilde{x}} \frac{\partial z}{\partial y}$$

or in Euler/Lagrange notation:

$$(f(g(\tilde{x})))' = \tilde{g}'(\tilde{x})f(g(\tilde{x}))$$

See <https://quickfem.com/finite-element-analysis/>, specifically https://quickfem.com/wp-content/uploads/IFEM.AppF_.pdf

See also https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Gradient#Relationship_with_Fr%C3%A9chet_derivative

This chain rule is like the univariate chain rule (Theorem 2.8), but the order matters now. The version presented here is for the gradient⁴ (column vector); the total derivative⁵ (row vector) would be the transpose of the gradient⁶.

⁴<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Gradient>

⁵https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Total_derivative

⁶https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Gradient#Relationship_with_total_derivative

Corollary 4.2 (Vector chain rule for quadratic forms).

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}}(\tilde{\varepsilon}(\tilde{\beta}) \cdot \tilde{\varepsilon}(\tilde{\beta})) = \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}} \tilde{\varepsilon}(\tilde{\beta}) \right) (2\tilde{\varepsilon}(\tilde{\beta}))$$

5 Additional resources

5.1 Calculus

- Kaplan (2022)
- Khuri (2003)
- Banner (2007)
- Miller (2016)
 - <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xYzQL0TUtBA>
 - http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ps2SBo_WjoE

5.2 Linear Algebra and Vector Calculus

- Fieller (2016)
- Banerjee and Roy (2014)
- Searle and Khuri (2017)

5.3 Numerical Analysis

- Hua Zhou⁷'s lecture notes for “UCLA Biostat 216 - Mathematical Methods for Biostatistics” (2023 Fall)⁸

5.4 Real Analysis

- Grinberg (2017)

Banerjee, Sudipto, and Anindya Roy. 2014. *Linear Algebra and Matrix Analysis for Statistics*. Vol. 181. Crc Press Boca Raton. <https://www.routledge.com/Linear-Algebra-and-Matrix-Analysis-for-Statistics/Banerjee-Roy/p/book/9781420095388>.

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Fieller, Nick. 2016. *Basics of Matrix Algebra for Statistics with R*. Chapman; Hall/CRC. <https://doi.org/10.1201/9781315370200>.

Grinberg, Raffi. 2017. *The Real Analysis Lifesaver: All the Tools You Need to Understand Proofs*. 1st ed. Princeton Lifesaver Study Guides. Princeton University Press. <https://press.princeton.edu/books/paperback/9780691172934/the-real-analysis-lifesaver>.

Kaplan, Daniel. 2022. *MOSAIC Calculus*. www.mosaic-web.org. www.mosaic-web.org⁹.

⁷<https://hua-zhou.github.io/>

⁸<https://ucla-biostat-216.github.io/2023fall/schedule/schedule.html>

⁹<https://www.mosaic-web.org>

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- Searle, Shayle R, and Andre I Khuri. 2017. *Matrix Algebra Useful for Statistics*. John Wiley & Sons.